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Republic of Zambia

**COSMETOLOGY EXPO AND MSME FINANCE, BDS AND
DIGITAL SOLUTIONS FAIR 2026**

SPONSORSHIP TIERS

**Ministry of Small and Medium Enterprise Development
Lusaka**

1. Platinum Sponsor (Investment: ZMW 160,000+)

Targeting the overall event or dominating major budget sections like Venue, Stage, and Branding.

- **Exhibition Space:** Complimentary premium placement for up to four (4) exhibition booths across the main expo hall, food court, and the finance, BDS & Digital Solutions.
- **Stage & Venue Branding:** * Premium branding on the main stage backdrop.
 - Company logo displayed on event screens.
- **Media & Publicity:** * Premium placement of company logo on promotional pull-up banners, flyers, and event posters.
 - Inclusion in all TV and radio promo slots, press releases, and social media campaigns.
 - Direct verbal recognition and marketing opportunities via the main stage, managed by the master of ceremonies during the opening ceremony, panel discussions, and awards presentation.
- **Lanyard & Registration Branding:** Exclusive opportunity to provide and brand the event lanyards and ID cards with the company logo, featuring direct accessibility to a QR code of the sponsor's choice for all attendees.
- **Program Integration:** Opportunity to deliver a brief keynote address during the opening ceremony and a dedicated slot on a Panel Discussions.

2. Gold Sponsor (Investment: ZMW 75,000 – ZMW 159,000)

Targeting specific functional categories such as Branding & Publicity or Catering & Hospitality.

- **Exhibition Space:** Complimentary premium placement for three (3) exhibition booths.
- **Stage & Venue Branding:** Company logo displayed on the stage backdrop side-wings and prominent banner placement within the VIP and panel discussion areas.
- **Media & Publicity:** * Logo placement on event posters, flyers, and social media promotional posts.
 - Acknowledgement in official media kits and press packs distributed to journalists.
- **Program Integration:** Opportunity to moderate or seat a representative on one of the panel discussions.

3. Silver Sponsor (Investment: ZMW 30,000 – ZMW 74,000)

Targeting technical sessions, live demonstrations, or the awards ceremony.

- **Exhibition Space:** Complimentary placement for two (2) standard exhibition booth.
- **Venue Branding:** Placement of up to two (2) company pull-up banners inside the main exhibition hall or registration area.
- **Media & Publicity:** Logo placement on event posters, flyers, and social media promotional posts
- **Program Integration:** Branded naming rights for one of the masterclasses, live professional demonstrations, or competition award categories (e.g., "[Sponsor Name] Innovation Award").

4. Bronze / In-Kind Partner (Investment: Up to ZMW 29,000 or Product/Service Value)

Targeting participant materials, session consumables, or competition prizes.

- **Venue Branding:** Placement of two (2) pull-up banner at the registration desk or technical demonstration area.
- **Media & Publicity:** Logo listed under "Partners" in the official program booklet and on collective sponsor appreciation banners.
- **Product Visibility:** Opportunity to distribute branded materials (notepads, pens, or product samples) inside the official delegate registration packs.

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Republic of Zambia

A CONCEPT NOTE ON

THE INAUGURAL COSMETOLOGY EXPO AND MSME

FINANCE FAIR 2026

Ministry of Small and Medium Enterprise Development
Lusaka
March 2026

1.0. BACKGROUND AND CONTEXT

The Ministry of Small and Medium Enterprise Development is mandated to foster the development and growth of MSMEs and Cooperatives. Globally, the beauty and personal care industry is valued at over \$500 billion, yet in Zambia, this sector remains largely fragmented, subsistence based, and informal.

Despite its informality, the cosmetology sector is one of the largest employers of youth and women in urban and peri-urban areas due to the low barriers to entry that exist in the sector. Currently, thousands of Zambian entrepreneurs in makeup artistry, hair technology, and organic skin care manufacturing operate without standardized certification, limited access to high-tier markets, and a total lack of specialized financial products.

To catalyze growth, the Ministry is launching a dual-track event: the Cosmetology Expo which will run concurrently with the MSME Finance Fair. This integrated approach ensures that as cosmetology practitioners professionalize their skills, they gain immediate access to the capital required for expansion. This event is scheduled for 15-16th July 2026 at ZCAS University in Lusaka.

2.0. PROBLEM STATEMENT

The Zambian cosmetology sector suffers from "The Missing Middle" phenomenon where micro enterprises struggle to scale into small or medium-sized businesses. Key challenges include:

- **Regulatory Gap:** A lack of synergy between practitioners and regulatory bodies leading to inconsistent service quality.
- **Capital Constraints:** Commercial banks often view beauty services as high risk, resulting in a high credit refusal rate for salon equipment and inventory.
- **Supply Chain Weakness:** Local manufacturers of organic soaps and oils lack the finishing and branding expertise to compete with imported luxury brands.

3.0. STRATEGIC INTERVENTIONS

The Cosmetology Expo will serve as a multi-dimensional platform for the following interventions:

3.1. The MSME Finance Fair (Sideline Event)

Running on the sidelines of the main expo, this fair will feature various banks and micro-finance institutions showcasing products specifically tailored for MSMEs.

- **Product Showcasing:** Banks will present asset financing for modern salon equipment and working capital solutions.

- On-site Consultations: Practitioners can engage directly with lenders to understand collateral requirements and loan pre-qualification

3.2. Formalization and Professional Standards

The Ministry will facilitate on-site clinics. This will ensure that the pathway is set to move beyond talent to certified professionals, a prerequisite for entering formal supply chains and international markets.

3.3. Innovation and Value Addition

The Expo will feature live demonstrations showcasing local manufacturers. This aligns with the 8th National Development Plan's pillar on Industrialization by encouraging the processing of local raw materials (such as Marula oil, Honey, and Shea butter) into finished cosmetic exports.

4.0. PROGRAMME STRUCTURE

The activation will be divided into four thematic areas, peaking at the main 2-day expo:

- Policy & Industry Panel Discussions: High-level interactive sessions featuring industry experts and regulatory bodies to discuss sector formalization, growth barriers, and the future of the beauty economy in Zambia.
- Live Professional Demonstrations: Real time showcases of makeup artistry, hair technology, and organic product manufacturing to highlight local innovation, value addition, and professional service standards.
- Financial Literacy: A dedicated sideline space for banks and financial service providers to interact with MSMEs
- The Grand Expo: 2 days of expo activities.

5.0. EXPECTED OUTCOMES

- Enhanced Industry Networking: Establishment of a formal networking platform connecting fragmented practitioners with regulatory bodies, training institutions, and high-tier market suppliers.
- Increased Regulatory Awareness: Greater understanding among informal practitioners regarding the benefits of formalization and the specific requirements for certification and professional standards.
- Improved Financial Literacy: Successful engagement between MSMEs and financial institutions, leading to a clearer understanding of collateral requirements and available specialized financial products.
- Market Visibility for Local Value Addition: Heightened awareness and consumer trust in Made in Zambia organic skin care and beauty products through live demonstrations and exhibition.

- Supplier Linkage Opportunities: Creation of direct channels for local manufacturers to interact with salon and spa owners for potential future supply chain integration.

6.o. TARGET STAKEHOLDERS AND STRATEGIC PARTNERS

The Cosmetology Expo 2026 adopts an inclusive, multi-sectoral approach. To ensure the successful formalization and growth of the sector, the Ministry seeks to bring on board a diverse range of stakeholders who constitute the Beauty Economy in Zambia:

- Speakers/moderators;
- Cosmetology businesses (beauty salons, spas, skincare clinics, etc.);
- Cosmetology training institutions;
- Product suppliers and manufacturers;
- Financial Institutions;
- Industry associations and networks; and
- Potential sponsors and partners.

7.o. DETAILED BUDGET

No.	Item Description	Unit	Qty	Unit Cost (ZMW)	Total (ZMW)
A. Pre-Planning, Coordination and Stakeholder Engagement					
1	Internal planning meetings (refreshments, stationery, logistics)	Meeting	6	3,500.00	21,000.00
2	Stakeholder consultative meeting	Meeting	1	18,000.00	18,000.00
3	Transport and local facilitation for planning meetings	Lump sum	1	10,000.00	10,000.00
4	Printing of concept notes, letters, and stakeholder packs	Lump sum	1	5,000.00	5,000.00
5	Communication and coordination (airtime/data/phone calls)	Lump sum	1	6,000.00	6,000.00
				Subtotal	60,000.00
B. Venue, Set-up and Exhibition Infrastructure					
6	Venue hire (2 days)	Days	2	20,000.00	40,000.00
7	Exhibition stands/booths	Booths	60	1,200.00	72,000.00
8	Tables	Table	60	120.00	7,200.00
9	Chairs	Chair	150	35.00	5,250.00
10	Tent/canopy hire	Lump sum	1	30,000.00	30,000.00
11	Stage set-up and backdrop	Lump sum	1	18,000.00	18,000.00
12	Podium and décor	Lump sum	1	8,000.00	8,000.00
13	Electrical set-up / extension cabling / power support	Lump sum	1	10,000.00	10,000.00

14	Venue cleaning and sanitation support	Lump sum	1	6,000.00	6,000.00
15	Security services	Days	2	5,000.00	10,000.00

Subtotal 206,450.00

C. Branding, Publicity and Communication

16	Event branding design and artwork	Lump sum	1	7,500.00	7,500.00
17	Pull-up banners	Banner	10	850.00	8,500.00
18	Main event banner / backdrop branding	Lump sum	1	7,000.00	7,000.00
19	Posters and flyers	Lump sum	1	6,500.00	6,500.00
20	Social media promotion and sponsored posts	Lump sum	1	10,000.00	10,000.00
21	Radio publicity / talk show slots	Lump sum	1	50,000.00	50,000.00
22	Television coverage / promo slots	Lump sum	1	25,000.00	25,000.00
23	Photography and videography	Days	2	6,500.00	13,000.00
24	Media kits / press packs	Lump sum	1	4,000.00	4,000.00

Subtotal 131,500.00

D. Training, Masterclasses, Panels and Technical Sessions

25	Facilitator honoraria	Person	12	3,000.00	36,000.00
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26	Moderators / session hosts	Person	4	2,000.00	8,000.00
27	Judges for competitions	Person	5	2,500.00	12,500.00
28	Session materials / stationery / handouts	Lump sum	1	8,000.00	8,000.00
29	Certificates for participants and winners	Lump sum	1	5,000.00	5,000.00
30	Technical demonstration consumables	Lump sum	1	20,000.00	20,000.00
31	Product formulation / live demo materials	Lump sum	1	15,000.00	15,000.00

Subtotal 104,500.00

E. Registration, Event Materials and Participant Support

32	Registration desk setup and materials	Lump sum	1	5,000.00	5,000.00
33	Name tags / badges / lanyards	Person	250	35.00	8,750.00
34	Programme booklets / agenda printing	Copy	250	35.00	8,750.00
35	Notepads and pens	Person	250	30.00	7,500.00
36	Event packs / folders	Person	200	60.00	12,000.00
37	Exhibitor orientation materials	Lump sum	1	4,500.00	4,500.00

Subtotal 46,500.00

F. Catering and Hospitality

38	Tea break – Day 1	Person	250	120.00	30,000.00
39	Lunch – Day 1	Person	250	180.00	45,000.00
40	Tea break – Day 2	Person	250	120.00	30,000.00
41	Lunch – Day 2	Person	250	180.00	45,000.00
42	VIP / special guest hospitality	Lump sum	1	12,000.00	12,000.00
43	Water and refreshments for exhibitors / technical teams	Lump sum	1	10,000.00	10,000.00

Subtotal 172,000.00

G. Transport, Field Mobilisation and Logistics Support

44	Local transport for mobilisation and coordination	Lump sum	1	18,000.00	18,000.00
45	Fuel and vehicle support	Lump sum	1	15,000.00	15,000.00
46	Pick-up / drop-off logistics for equipment and materials	Lump sum	1	12,000.00	12,000.00
47	Staff logistical support during event	Lump sum	1	10,000.00	10,000.00

Subtotal 55,000.00

H. Awards, Recognition and Competitions

48	Trophies / plaques	Item	10	800.00	8,000.00
49	Medals / certificates	Lump sum	1	4,500.00	4,500.00

50	Competition prizes	Lump sum	1	30,000.00	30,000.00
51	Awards ceremony décor / presentation support	Lump sum	1	8,000.00	8,000.00

Subtotal 50,500.00

I. Documentation, Monitoring, Evaluation and Reporting

52	Feedback forms / data collection tools	Lump sum	1	3,500.00	3,500.00
53	Data entry and event analysis support	Lump sum	1	5,000.00	5,000.00
54	Report writing, editing, and printing	Lump sum	1	7,500.00	7,500.00
55	Post-event review meeting	Meeting	1	8,000.00	8,000.00

Subtotal 24,000.00

**Contingency
(10%)**

Contingency 85, 045.00

**GRAND TOTAL
(ZMW)**

935, 495.00

7.0. CONCLUSION

The Inaugural Cosmetology Expo & MSME Finance Fair 2026 is a catalytic event designed to turn talent into trade. By hosting these two events concurrently, the Ministry is ensuring that the beauty sector's transition toward professional standards is backed by immediate access to the necessary capital and financial services. This dual-track approach signals that the beauty and personal care industry is no longer a peripheral activity, but a core pillar of Zambia's diversified economy.

